

Tooba Khan, Kiran Shezadi & Zainab Bibi.

⇒ Introduction: What is meant by helping behaviour?

• Helping behaviour: Voluntary actions intended to help the others, with reward regarded or disregarded. It is a type of prosocial behaviour (voluntary action intended to help or benefit another individual or group of individuals, such as sharing, comforting, rescuing and helping).

Example:

volunteer work, donating money, or helping a neighbor move a heavy item of furniture.

The most striking type of prosocial behaviour is Altruism, where a person takes on a cost to help another person with no expectation or possibility of receiving a benefit in return.

• Types of Helping behaviour:

While prosocial behaviour is often presented as a single, uniform dimension, some research suggests that there are different types. These types are distinguished based on why they are produced and include:

- 1 Proactive & These are prosocial actions that serve self-benefitting purposes.
- 2 Reactive & These are actions that are performed in response to individual needs.
- 3 Altruistic & These include actions that are meant to help others without any expectations of personal gain.

Theories of Helping Behaviour &

Theories of helping behaviour are;

- i- Negative state relief model (1973)
- ii- Reciprocal-altruism theory (1971)
- iii- Empathy altruism hypothesis
- iv- Kin selection theory
- v- Bystander effect

i- Negative state relief Model

The negative state relief model (1973) states that people help in order to alleviate the discomfort caused by negative emotions.

For example, guilty participants donate more blood and report a significant reduction in their guilty feeling after the donation.

According to Cialdini's Negative state relief model, people help for selfish reasons. Specifically we help only if we decide that there is no other way to relief a negative state and we believe that helping will allow us to relief the negative state.

seek to social understand why people engage in helping behaviours that are beneficial to others, but costly to the individual performing the action.

Psychologists suggest that there are a number of reasons why people engage in prosocial behaviour.

1 Evolutionary influences:

Evolutionary psychologists often explain prosocial behaviours in terms of the principles of natural selection. While putting your own safety in danger makes it less likely that you will survive to pass on your own genes, kin selection suggests that helping members of your own genetic family makes it more likely that your kin will survive and pass on genes to future generations.

Researchers have been able to produce some evidence that people are often more likely to help those to whom they are closely related.

2 Personal benefits:

Prosocial behaviours are often seen as being compelled by a number of factors including egoistic reasons (doing things to improve one's self-image), reciprocal benefits (doing something nice for someone so that they may one day return the favor), and more altruistic reasons (performing actions purely out of empathy for another individual).

iii- Stress-reducing effects: Research has also found that engaging in prosocial behaviours helps mitigate the negative emotional effects of stress. Helping others may actually be a great way to reduce the impact of stress in your life.

● Ingroup And Outgroup Helping Behaviour

* Ingroup:

An ingroup is a social group to which a person psychologically identifies as being a member. Ingroup members are perceived as moral which increases the motivation to help them.

- People in every social setting make positive and negative evaluation of members of other groups.
- Members of ingroup generally hold overly positive views of themselves and unfairly negative views of various outgroups.

* Out-group:

Outgroup is a social group toward which a person feels a sense of competition and opposition.

Ingroup members are perceived to be more moral, which increases the motivation to help them while outgroup members are perceived to be more immoral,

DATE: ___/___/___

affecting a person's preference to
engage in prosocial behaviour
leading to reduced prosocial behaviour.

